

“Look back at time ... before our birth. In this way Nature holds before our eyes the mirror of our future after death. Is this so grim, so gloomy?”

Because this draws a kind of parallel between pre-birth and post-death times,
this is sometimes called the **symmetry argument**.

One can think of Luncratius' second argument as a reply to this objection.

Most of us have a negative feeling about future nonexistence which we do not have about past nonexistence. Lucretius' challenge is to justify this difference in our attitudes.

A natural reply is to say: 'OK, I agree that there is nothing especially fearsome about my past nonexistence. But future nonexistence is different; I should fear my future nonexistence even if I do not fear my past nonexistence.'



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different identities.

Another reply is to say: 'OK, I agree that there is nothing especially

fear about my past not existence. But future not existence is different;

I should fear my future not my past



nonexistence.